

Special Expense Justification and Approval Memorandum

Project Name: Analysis and Regulation of Cognitive Neural Circuits

Project No.: NSF-COG-2024-07 **Date:** July 3, 2024 **From:** Zhang

Mingyuan, Principal Investigator **To:** Wang Jianguo, Department Head;
Liu Fang, Finance Department

Subject: Justification for Accommodation Expenses During

International Conference Attendance

1. Background

The undersigned will attend the 12th International Neuroscience Symposium in the San Diego area, California, USA, from July 19 to 21, 2024. Due to the following objective circumstances, the accommodation expenses for this trip are expected to exceed the standard per diem accommodation rate applicable to routine domestic business travel:

2. Justification for Elevated Costs

(a) **Peak-season pricing:** July is the peak tourist and conference season in the San Diego coastal area. Hotel rates in the Del Mar and surrounding regions increase significantly during this period due to concurrent events and seasonal demand.

(b) **Proximity to conference venue:** To minimize daily commuting time and ensure full participation in all conference sessions (including early morning plenary sessions and evening collaboration meetings), accommodation was necessarily arranged at a location within close

proximity to the conference venue. Hotels in the immediate vicinity of major conference centers command a substantial rate premium.

(c) **Safety and logistical considerations:** As an international traveler unfamiliar with the local area, selecting a well-established, centrally located hotel ensures personal safety, reliable transportation access, and efficient time management—all of which directly serve the project's objectives.

(d) **Duration efficiency:** The accommodation period was limited to the minimum necessary (2 nights covering the full 3-day conference), avoiding any unnecessary extension that would increase total costs.

3. Cost-Benefit Assessment

The total accommodation cost, including all applicable taxes (occupancy tax, tourism assessments), is commensurate with the prevailing market rates for comparable accommodations in the San Diego area during the conference period. The expense is directly and exclusively attributable to the execution of project tasks as documented in the approved work plan and travel approval form.

4. Approval

The above justification has been reviewed and the accommodation expenses for this trip have been confirmed as a **special circumstance** that is reasonable and necessary for the fulfillment of project objectives. This determination is based on the documented project requirements,

prevailing local market conditions, and the specific logistical constraints of international conference attendance.

Role	Name	Opinion	Signature	Date
Project Leader	Zhang Mingyuan	Justification is accurate and complete.	Zhang Ming	July 3, 2024
Department Head	Wang Jianguo	Reviewed. Costs are justified given the circumstances. Approved as special circumstance.	Wang Jianguo	July 4, 2024
Finance Department	Liu Fang	Market rate verification completed. Confirmed consistent with San Diego area conference-season pricing. App		

Approved maximum reimbursement limit: USD 1,500 (inclusive of taxes and surcharges).

Date: July 4, 2024